



CITY OF PHILADELPHIA
DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC HEALTH

BOARD OF HEALTH: 3/12/2026
LAW DEPARTMENT: 3/17/2026
RECORDS DEPARTMENT:

**AMENDMENTS TO REGULATIONS GOVERNING THE CONTROL OF
COMMUNICABLE AND NONCOMMUNICABLE DISEASES AND CONDITIONS**

WHEREAS, the Pennsylvania Disease Control and Prevention Act of 1955, P.L. 1510 (April 23, 1956), 35 P.S. § 52.1 et seq., (the DCPA) and Section 6-201 of The Philadelphia Code authorize the Board of Health to establish lists of reportable diseases and conditions; and

WHEREAS, Section 4 of the DCPA and Section 6-202 of the Code require health care providers and laboratories identifying these reportable diseases and conditions designated by the Board, to report the occurrence of such diseases and conditions to the Department of Public Health (“Department”); and

WHEREAS, the Philadelphia Board of Health has adopted *Regulations Governing the Control of Communicable and Non-communicable Diseases and Conditions* (“Regulations”); and

WHEREAS, the Regulations contain a listing of such diseases and the methods of reporting the occurrence thereof; and

WHEREAS, Section 5 of the DCPA and subsection 6-204(1) of the Code authorize the Department to order the isolation of any person found by an attending physician or by the Department to have any disease listed by the Board as a quarantinable disease, for such period and in such manner as the Board may by regulation prescribe in order to protect public health and to prevent the spread of such disease; and

WHEREAS, Section 5 of the DCPA and subsections 6-204(2) and 6-204(3) of the Code authorize the Department to order the quarantine of any person who is reasonably suspected of having or being exposed to any disease listed by the Board as a quarantinable disease or order the isolation of any person found by an attending physician or by the Department to be a carrier of any disease listed by the Board as a quarantinable disease for such period and in such manner as the Board may by regulation prescribe in order to protect the public health and prevent the spread of such disease; and

WHEREAS, the Board of Health finds that Hepatitis E, Hepatitis D, novel coronavirus, COVID-19, seasonal influenza, Q Fever, and Respiratory syncytial virus (RSV) are infectious diseases of public health importance, and therefore should be included on the list of reportable conditions in the Regulations;

NOW, THEREFORE, the Board of Health hereby amends the *Regulations Governing the Control of Communicable and Non-communicable Diseases and Conditions* to read as follows (additions in **Bold** and deletions in ~~Strikethrough~~):

REGULATIONS GOVERNING THE CONTROL OF COMMUNICABLE AND
NONCOMMUNICABLE DISEASES AND CONDITIONS

2. REPORTABLE DISEASES AND CONDITIONS

The Board declares the following diseases, unusual outbreaks of illness, noncommunicable diseases and conditions, poisonings and occupational diseases to be reportable:

(a) Diseases, Conditions, Etc.

* * *

(15) Hepatitis, viral

(a) ~~Type A~~ **Hepatitis A**

(b) ~~Type B~~ **Hepatitis B**

(c) Hepatitis C

(d) Hepatitis, other viral etiologies, **including Hepatitis D and Hepatitis E.**

[...]

(*) **Novel Coronavirus**, strains causing severe disease or having pandemic potential

(*) **COVID-19 (Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome Coronavirus 2 [SARS-CoV-2])**

(*) **Influenza, seasonal**

(*) **Q Fever**

(*) **Respiratory syncytial virus (RSV)**

* * *

10. REGULATIONS PERTAINING TO THE CONTROL OF THE INFECTED INDIVIDUALS, CONTACTS, AND ENVIRONMENT FOR EACH REPORTABLE DISEASE

(n) ~~Hepatitis A (viral, infectious, acute catarrhal jaundice)~~

- (1) ~~Reporting. Report shall be made to the Acute Communicable Disease Control Program.~~
- (2) ~~Isolation. Isolation precautions shall be observed in handling blood or blood products and excretions until one week after onset of illness. The patient shall be excluded from all food and drink preparation, processing, and serving for public consumption for a period of one week after onset of illness or for as long as indicated by the results of appropriate laboratory exams.~~
- (3) ~~Concurrent disinfection. Equipment contaminated with blood, serum, or other excretions shall be disinfected.~~
- (4) ~~Terminal disinfection. No terminal disinfection shall be required.~~
- (5) ~~Quarantine. No quarantine of contacts shall be required.~~

(o) ~~Hepatitis B (viral, serum, homologous serum jaundice)~~

- (1) ~~Reporting. Report shall be made to the Acute Communicable Disease Control Program.~~
- (2) ~~Isolation. Isolation precautions shall be observed in handling blood or blood products and excretions until one week after cessation of signs and symptoms of the disease or until two weeks after onset of illness, whichever is longer. Blood or blood products containing hepatitis B antigen shall be considered infectious.~~
- (3) ~~Concurrent disinfection. Equipment contaminated with blood, serum, or other excretions shall be disinfected.~~
- (4) ~~Terminal disinfection. No terminal disinfection shall be required.~~
- (5) ~~Quarantine. No quarantine of contacts shall be required.~~

(o.1) ~~Hepatitis C and Hepatitis, other viral etiologies~~ **Hepatitis (Hepatitis A, Hepatitis B, Hepatitis C, Hepatitis D, and Hepatitis E)**

- (1) ~~Reporting. Report shall be made to the Acute Communicable Disease Control Program~~ **Rreport shall be made to the Department within 5 days, in a manner specified by the Department. Babies born to Hepatitis B positive birthing people should be reported within 24 hours, in a manner specified by the Department.**

- (2) Isolation. Observe standard precautions for ~~bloodborne pathogens~~ **route of transmission.**
- (3) Concurrent disinfection. Environments contaminated with blood or infectious body fluids shall be disinfected.
- (4) Terminal disinfection. Terminal disinfection shall consist of thorough cleaning.
- (5) Quarantine. No quarantine is required.

[...]

(*) **Novel Coronavirus**, strains causing severe disease or having pandemic potential

- (1) Reporting. Report to the ~~Acute Communicable Disease Control Program~~ **Department** by telephone or other equally prompt means immediately, and not more than within 24 hours of suspicion.
 - a. A strain of coronavirus causing severe disease or having pandemic potential is one that is either (i) capable of causing severe respiratory disease, such as pneumonia or Acute Respiratory Distress Syndrome, (ii) otherwise having potential to produce a pandemic, or both. Such strains include, but are not limited to, those associated with SARS, MERS, ~~COVID-19~~,[†] and future novel strains meeting this definition.
- (2) Isolation. Patient shall be isolated in a hospital, its equivalent, **as determined by the Department**, or home, until the communicable period is over. The communicable period will be defined by the Department in accord with characteristics of the specific pathogen. ~~For hospitalized cases, precautions should consist of airborne, droplet, and contact precautions.~~ **Appropriate transmission-based precautions should be applied when in a healthcare facility.**
- (3) Concurrent disinfection. Infection control precautions appropriate to interrupt spread of ~~respiratory droplets, hand hygiene and thorough cleaning of patient rooms and bathroom facilities and appropriate disposal or washing of linens and articles contaminated by body fluids of the~~ **pathogen while the patient is in the healthcare facility.**
- (4) Terminal Disinfection. Terminal disinfection shall consist of thorough cleaning and disinfection. Because of the potential for airborne transmission, unprotected individuals should not enter a vacated room

until sufficient time has elapsed for air exchanges to remove potentially infectious particles. If the rate of air exchange is known, use references materials to determine when a room can be safely entered. If the rate of air exchange for a room is unknown, the room should be vacated for a minimum of four hours.

- (5) Quarantine. If deemed necessary by the Department, persons who had close contact with individuals with novel strains of coronavirus will be confined for a specified period of time following the most recent exposure, and monitored by the Department for the appearance of disease symptoms. The duration of confinement will be determined by the Department in accord with characteristics of the specific pathogen.
- (*) Multisystem Inflammatory Syndrome (MIS), which includes Multisystem Inflammatory Syndrome in adults (MIS-A) and Multisystem Inflammatory Syndrome in children (MIS-C)
 - (1) Reporting. ~~Routinely Report to the Acute Communicable Disease Control Program~~ **Department within 5 days**, in a manner specified by the Department, if the criteria established by the Centers for Disease Control, as they may be updated, are met.

[...]

- (*) **COVID-19 (Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome Coronavirus 2 [SARS-CoV-2]);**
 - (1) **Reporting. Routinely report to the Department within 5 days, in a manner specified by the Department. Pediatric deaths and institutional outbreaks as specified by the Division of Disease Control, should be reported immediately.**
 - (2) **Isolation. Routine isolation, as for respiratory viruses.**
 - (3) **Concurrent disinfection. Environments contaminated with infectious body fluids shall be disinfected.**
 - (4) **Terminal disinfection. Terminal disinfection shall consist of thorough cleaning.**
 - (5) **Quarantine. No quarantine required.**
- (*) **Influenza, seasonal**

- (1) Reporting.** Routinely report to the Department within 5 days, in a manner specified by the Department. Pediatric deaths and institutional outbreaks as specified by the Division of Disease Control, should be reported immediately.
- (2) Isolation.** As directed by the Department.
- (3) Concurrent disinfection.** Concurrent disinfection shall consist of thorough cleaning and disinfection.
- (4) Terminal Disinfection.** Terminal disinfection shall consist of thorough cleaning and disinfection.
- (5) Quarantine.** No quarantine required.

(*) Respiratory syncytial virus (RSV)

- (1) Reporting.** Routinely report to the Department within 5 days, in a manner specified by the Department. Pediatric deaths and institutional outbreaks as specified by the Department, should be reported immediately.
- (2) Isolation.** As directed by the Department.
- (3) Concurrent disinfection.** Environments contaminated with infectious body fluids shall be disinfected.
- (4) Terminal disinfection.** Terminal disinfection shall consist of thorough cleaning.
- (5) Quarantine.** No quarantine is required.

(*) Q Fever

- (1) Reporting.** Immediately reportable to the Department within 24 hours, in a manner specified by the Department.
- (2) Isolation.** No isolation required
- (3) Concurrent disinfection.** Environments contaminated with infectious body fluids shall be disinfected.
- (4) Terminal disinfection.** Terminal disinfection shall consist of thorough cleaning.

(5) Quarantine. No quarantine is required.